ATT&CK® EVALUATIONS · METHODOLOGY

HOW WE TEST.
HOW WE SCORE.
WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU.

ATT&CK® Evaluations test security products against real adversary behaviors in controlled, transparent conditions — with no vendor-controlled demos, no cherry-picked results. This page explains our methodology and the new scoring framework for Enterprise 2026.

ALL READERS FOR CUSTOMERS FOR VENDORS

FOR PARTICIPATING VENDORS

What you need to know to prepare for evaluation

Participation demonstrates confidence in transparency and a commitment to continuous improvement. Here's what the scoring system rewards, what it penalizes, and how to perform well.

WHAT OUR SCORING REWARDS

WHAT LOWERS YOUR SCORE

- × Alert spam — generating many low-context alerts for a single behavior
- × Fragmented cases — 50 behaviors in 50 separate cases vs. 1 consolidated incident
- × Late blocks — blocking ransomware encryption after credentials and lateral movement already succeeded
- × Missing block context — no user identity, no ATT&CK mapping, no remediation guidance

WHAT IMPROVES YOUR SCORE

- ✔ Technique-level detection with ATT&CK mapping explicitly identified
- ✔ One consolidated, correlated incident case per attack chain
- ✔ Early blocking — before or at first critical technique in the chain
- ✔ Full block transparency — WHO, WHAT, WHEN, WHERE, HOW, WHY, and Recommended Action
- ✔ Precision — correctly allowing all legitimate business activity

📎 **Best practice for detection:** Generate one high-quality, consolidated alert per behavior with correlated telemetry accessible in the same workflow. This achieves DC-3 while minimizing analyst burden — and maximizes your Detection Precision score.

KEY SCORING PRINCIPLES TO INTERNALIZE

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR PRODUCT
Behavior-level scoring	DC is scored per ATT&CK technique, not per alert. 15 alerts for one technique = one DC score based on best alert quality. Consolidation is rewarded.
ACW applies to detection only	Attack Chain Weighting applies to Detection Coverage. For protection, Prevention Impact Weighting (PIW) already captures technique criticality through attack-objective positioning — no double-counting.
Block timing is primary	For protection, when you block determines the PIW multiplier. Blocking at Stage 1 (Critical, 1.0×) is worth twice blocking at Stage 3 (Medium, 0.5×), regardless of context quality.
Block context is secondary	Within a timing tier, full context (6–7/7 elements) achieves PC-3 or PC-2; partial context achieves PC-2 or PC-1. Context cannot compensate for late timing.
"Observe before block" is valid	Intentional holds for threat intelligence collection can receive higher PIW credit. Document your strategy and ensure telemetry demonstrates active observation, not a missed detection.

⚠️ **Lower scores identify improvement opportunities for 2027.** Scores reflect performance against these specific scenarios — not absolute product quality. The detailed per-technique results published openly are the most actionable data for your engineering roadmap.

Enterprise

Enterprise 2026

All Evaluations →

Past Participants

Participate in an Evaluation

Methodology

Overview

Scoring Specification

Citation Policy

Resources

About Evaluations

Our Team

FAQ

Blog

Contact Us

Emulation Library